

PUBLIC SERVICE

The Loudoun County School Board provides for Public Service Leave for full-time employees who have successfully completed three (3) continuous years of service in Loudoun County Public Schools (LCPS). This policy sets forth the provisions therefore.

A. Service on the Loudoun County School Board Not Eligible. By law, employees elected to the Loudoun County School Board are not eligible for this leave, pursuant to Policy 2110 (Qualification of School Board Members) and Policy 7520 (Non-School Employment).

B. Permissible Leave.

1 Candidates for Public Office. Public Service Leave without pay, not to exceed sixty (60) consecutive workdays, may be granted for campaign purposes to employees who are candidates for public office.

2 Elected/Appointed Public Officers. Employees who are elected or appointed to public office may be approved for Public Service Leave without pay. If approved, the duration of such leave shall be of sufficient length to permit the performance of all required duties of the public office.

3 Meetings. Employees who are elected or appointed to public office (including appointments to General Assembly staff positions) may be granted leave without pay for attendance at committee, commission, or other meetings as required by their respective offices.

C. Conditions of Public Service Leave.

1. Approval. Written requests for leave should be made to the LCPS Chief Human Resources Officer (CHRO) or designee. Approval of Public Service Leave shall be at the discretion of the CHRO or designee. The CHRO or designee, in arriving at such a decision, shall consider whether or not a qualified replacement is available to a staff member and such other factors as the CHRO may deem relevant to the prompt and efficient operation of the school, office, or department.

2. Substitutes. When an employee or administrator has made a request for a substitute in advance for purposes of requesting Public Service Leave, and the requested Public Service Leave is no longer needed, the employee must notify the appropriate authority to cancel the request for a substitute no later than one (1) hour after the start of the workday prior to the workday for which the substitute was requested.

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3. Benefits Repayment. In order to continue coverage under Group Life Insurance and Group Health Insurance, an employee approved for more than five days of Public Service Leave in any one contract/appointment year shall pay the per diem basis of these benefits. This cost will be billed to the employee by the Business & Financial Services department after the employee has returned to work.

Former Policy 7-69: Adopted 1/2/96

Revised: 5/28/96, 7/1/97, 3/27/12, 8/8/17

Current Revision: 8/13/24

Legal Reference: [Va. Code § 22.1-30](#)

Cross-Reference: Policy [2210](#), Qualification of School Board Members; Policy [7520](#), Non-School Employment